

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Stipulated Factual Basis

United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v. Mateo Serrano Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Docket Entry 23 Filed November 18, 2025

For purposes of Mateo Serrano's plea to Count One, the parties stipulate that the government could present evidence establishing the following facts beyond a reasonable doubt. All entities, people, amounts, and events are fictional. The narrative deliberately excludes financial credentials, account numbers, routing instructions, concealment methods, and operational details that could be misused.

Between August 4 and November 2, 2025, Serrano knowingly participated in an agreement to submit materially false reimbursement claims for services not performed against the fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative. At least one communication in furtherance of the agreement crossed state lines through ordinary commercial systems. Serrano understood the essential fraudulent object and acted with intent to help obtain money through the false claims.

The government would identify the charged offense as conspiracy to commit wire fraud under 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343. Serrano admits the existence of the agreement, his knowing and voluntary participation, and the intended wire-fraud object. He does not admit an aggravating-role conclusion by signing this factual basis.

Fictional Cooperative and Claim Categories

Meridian Community Supply Cooperative is a wholly fictional organization used only for this training record. It administered a reimbursement program for qualifying community-service vendors. The charged claims represented that listed services had been completed and were eligible for payment when, as the participants knew, the identified services had not been performed.

The government could present ordinary business records, witness testimony, and nonprivileged communications showing the mismatch between the claims and the cooperative's service records. This stipulation does not reproduce a claim form, approval sequence, authentication feature, or payment path. Those mechanics are neither necessary to the plea nor appropriate for a synthetic public exercise.

The parties agree that the aggregate loss caused by the conspiracy was \$186,400. That amount also supplies the agreed restitution figure, subject to the court's lawful order and credit for any payment received. Serrano does not dispute that the false statements were material to the cooperative's reimbursement decisions. The stipulated amount concerns the offense as a whole and does not decide which participant supervised another or how the advisory role adjustment should be resolved.

Duration and Completion Date

The charged agreement began no earlier than August 4, 2025, and continued through November 2, 2025. On November 2, members completed the final act attributed to the charged conspiracy. Serrano remained a knowing participant through that date. The offense therefore ended after the November 1 effective date of the 2025 Sentencing Guidelines Manual.

The parties include the completion date because it bears on selection of the Guidelines Manual, not because they agree on every sentencing calculation. They do not identify any disadvantage requiring use of an earlier Manual as a whole. The court and probation office remain responsible for applying U.S.S.G. § 1B1.11 and for considering any timely legal objection.

No conduct after November 2 is charged as part of Count One. Later investigation, arrest, plea, and sentencing events are procedural rather than additional offense acts. This temporal boundary prevents the stipulation from drifting into uncharged conduct. It also makes clear that the plea date itself does not determine the Manual; the agreed offense-completion date supplies the relevant premise.

Five Criminally Responsible Participants

Exactly five people were criminally responsible participants in the fictional conspiracy: Mateo Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt. Each knowingly joined the same unlawful agreement. No unwitting employee, cooperative worker, service recipient, or investigator is counted toward the five-participant total.

Serrano admits his own participation and agrees that the activity involved five participants for purposes of the numerical predicate addressed at sentencing. He does not admit that he was an organizer, leader, manager, or supervisor. In particular, he does not agree that his interactions with Pared constituted management or supervision of her as a person.

The government expects to rely on abstract communications and task assignments to support its position regarding Pared. Serrano expects to characterize those exchanges as coordination among participants of equal standing. The parties reserve that dispute for the Rule 32 process. They agree that ownership of an item, handling of funds, or coordination of an activity, standing alone, will not be treated as proof that Serrano managed or supervised another criminally responsible person.

Serrano's Knowing Participation

Serrano knew that the reimbursement representations were false and that the cooperative would rely on them when releasing funds. He knowingly associated himself with the agreement and took steps intended to help the shared fraudulent objective. His participation was not accidental, clerical, or the product of a misunderstanding about whether the services had occurred.

The evidence available to the government would include Serrano's own adopted admissions, testimony from fictional witnesses, and records showing his awareness of the claims' false character. The stipulation summarizes that proof without revealing a template, system process, contact channel, or sequence for submitting a claim. It identifies culpable intent while preserving a safe, non-actionable record.

Serrano understands that conspiracy liability does not require completion of every contemplated payment or personal transmission of every communication. He admits the agreement and his intentional participation in it. He also understands that this admission does not waive the reserved factual dispute about relative role. Culpable membership and managerial authority are distinct questions, and only the former is resolved by the plea.

Interstate Communication and Fraudulent Object

At least one member caused an interstate wire communication in furtherance of the false reimbursement scheme. The communication used an ordinary commercial channel and was reasonably foreseeable to members of the agreement. The parties do not identify its technical path, endpoint, credentials, or message format because those details are unnecessary to establish the admitted federal nexus.

The object was to obtain money from Meridian Community Supply Cooperative through materially false statements about whether reimbursable services had been performed. The participants intended the cooperative to rely on those representations. The claims were capable of influencing payment decisions, and funds were released on claims within the charged period.

Serrano admits that he intended the shared fraudulent result. He does not contend that the statements were immaterial or that he believed the services had occurred. The parties nevertheless avoid attributing every act of every participant to him for sentencing purposes. Any relevant-conduct or role conclusion beyond the express admissions must be supported through the presentence process and resolved by the court under the applicable burden and standard.

Matters Not Resolved by This Stipulation

This factual basis does not resolve application of U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b). The government may argue that Serrano managed or supervised Pared, and Serrano may object. The court may consider evidence presented through the probation report, written submissions, and sentencing hearing. No sentence in this document treats management of property, assets, or activity as a substitute for management of a person.

The stipulation also does not promise a sentence or bind the court to an estimated range. The parties anticipate criminal-history category I, but the probation office will verify the record. Restitution is stipulated at \$186,400, while the manner and schedule of payment remain for the judgment. The parties make no additional financial or forfeiture agreement.

Finally, this document does not alter the plea agreement's appeal waiver or its express complete-denial-of-allocation exception. The written agreement controls those terms, and the court's personal Rule 11 inquiry will determine whether Serrano understands them. A preserved district-court objection to the role adjustment does not by itself reserve an appellate Guidelines claim.

Adoption and Certification

Serrano has reviewed this factual basis with Arden. He agrees that the stated facts are true and that they provide an independent basis for a guilty plea to Count One. He understands that the government could offer admissible evidence consistent with this summary if the case proceeded to trial. He signs voluntarily and without reliance on an undisclosed promise.

Ives certifies that the government could support the stipulated elements and amount through fictional evidence identified in discovery. Arden certifies that she has explained the distinction between admitting knowing participation and reserving the person-management question. All counsel agree that the document intentionally omits actionable mechanics and private identifiers.

The parties request that Judge Elara Venn consider this stipulation during the Rule 11 hearing. Their signatures do not require acceptance of the plea, dictate a Guidelines finding, or limit the court's duty to determine voluntariness and factual sufficiency. This is the complete factual stipulation accompanying the agreement filed on November 18, 2025.

Mateo Serrano Fictional Defendant

Celia Arden Fictional Defense Counsel

Bram Ives Fictional Government Counsel